



FIREFIGHTER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Firefighters are emergency personnel who rescue and protect people, animals, and property in a range of accidents or emergencies, from fires, traffic incidents, and floods, to bomb threats and environmental hazards. They educate the public on fire prevention and safety, and respond to emergency call-outs in order to extinguish fires, bring trapped people or animals to safety, and administer first aid before medical services arrive.



SALARY

Newly qualified firefighter ★★★★★

Station officer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Competitive industry in which applicants often outnumber vacancies • Challenging profession with a tough selection process • Good opportunities for promotion and career development

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Health and safety • Community welfare and service • Physical Education (PE) • English • Mathematics • Science



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A reasonable standard of school is required. Firefighters must pass a series of physical and psychological tests.



LIFESTYLE Firefighters work on call or in shifts to provide 24-hour cover, including weekends and holidays. They typically work 48 hours a week.



LOCATION Firefighters are based at a fire station that houses firefighting equipment, and travel to locations to respond to emergencies as they occur.



THE REALITIES The job can be stressful and physically demanding. Firefighters are exposed to dangerous situations, such as unstable, smoke-filled buildings.

RELATED CAREERS

► **ARMY SOLDIER** *see pp. 230–231*

► **POLICE OFFICER** *see pp. 240–241*

► **PARAMEDIC** *see pp. 250–251*

► **DOG HANDLER** Works with trained dogs to detect and prevent crime, protect property, or find missing people. Dog handlers may work for the police force, the fire and rescue services, the armed services, the security industry, or customs and border control.



In 2011 in the United States, nearly 2.2 million calls to the fire service were false alarms.